

NT44 Enrichment

†E1. What are some distinctive features of 1 John?:

As one of Jesus Christ's original Apostles, John was a special witness of the resurrected Savior. John began this letter by declaring that he had personally seen, heard, and touched the resurrected Jesus Christ. Expanding on this personal witness, John invited his readers to have "fellowship" not only with John and those who ministered with him, but also "with the Father, and with his Son Jesus Christ" (1 John 1:3). Love is a central theme of John's First Epistle. Elder Bruce R. McConkie (1915–85) of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles summarized 1 John's theme of divine love as follows:

"That God is love;

"That love is the foundation upon which all personal righteousness rests;

"That all the purposes and plans of Deity are based on his infinite and eternal love; and

"That if men will personify that love in their lives, they will become like the Lord himself and have eternal life with him" (*Doctrinal New Testament Commentary*, 3 vols. [1965–73], 3:371).

†E2. **1 John 1:1-3. Apostolic Witness "from the Beginning":** John spoke about how he and others had personally seen, heard, and touched the resurrected Jesus Christ (see 1 John 1:1–3). John apparently wanted his readers to understand that he was writing this letter as his personal witness of the resurrected Christ (see Luke 24:36–39; Acts 1:3). John's testimony of Jesus Christ and His role in our salvation powerfully refuted the false teachings that were then entering into the Church.

†E3. **Brigham Young:** "Take courage, brethren ... plow your land and sow wheat, plant your potatoes. It is our duty to preach the Gospel, gather Israel, pay tithing and build temples. The worst fear I have about this people is that they will get rich in this country, forget God and His people, wax fat, and kick themselves out of the Church and go to hell. This people will stand mobbing, robbing, poverty, and all manner of persecution and be true. But my greatest fear is that they cannot stand wealth." (quoted by Spencer W. Kimball, *The Miracle of Forgiveness*, 48)

†E4. **John Taylor:** "It was said of olden time—'Love not the world, neither the things that are in the world. If any man love the world, the love of the Father is not in him.' (1 John 2:15.) That is as true today as it was eighteen hundred years ago. It is proper that we, as elders of Israel, and as heads of families, should reflect upon these things, for in many instances we are setting examples before our children that will tend to plunge them to perdition. Is this what we are gathered here for? I tell you, Nay; we are gathered here to serve God and

keep his commandments, and to build up his Zion upon the earth." (*The Gospel Kingdom*, 230-231)

†E5. **Elder Robert D. Hales:** "As children, we learned how to keep darkness away by turning on a light. Sometimes, when our parents went away for the evening, we would turn on every light in the house! We understood the physical law that is also a spiritual law: light and darkness cannot occupy the same space at the same time.

"Light dispels darkness. When light is present, darkness is vanquished and must depart. More importantly, darkness cannot conquer light unless the light is diminished or departs. When the spiritual light of the Holy Ghost is present, the darkness of Satan departs.

"... We are engaged in a battle between the forces of light and darkness. If it were not for the Light of Jesus Christ and His gospel, we would be doomed to the destruction of darkness" ("[Out of Darkness into His Marvelous Light](#)," *Ensign*, May 2002, 70; see [D&C 93:39](#)).

†E6. Love One Another:

As I have loved you, Love one another.

This new commandment: Love one another.

By this shall men know Ye are my disciples, If ye have love One to another. (Hymn #308)

†E7. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** "My widowed mother understood that principle. 'Pray about your feelings,' she used to say. She taught her three children to pray for the right kind of feelings about their experiences—positive or negative—and about the people they knew. If our feelings are good, we are more likely to have appropriate desires, to take right actions, and to act for the right reasons." (*Pure in Heart*, 151)

†E8. **Ezra Taft Benson:** "The world largely ignores the first and great commandment—to love God—but talks a lot about loving their brother. They worship at the altar of man..."

"The attitude of the world is reflected in a phrase of falsehood that reads, 'Presume not God to scan, the proper study of mankind is man.' But only those who know and love God can best love and serve his children, for only God fully understands his children and knows what is best for their welfare. Therefore, one needs to be in tune with God to best help his children..."

"Therefore, if you desire to help your fellowmen the most, then you must put the first commandment first.

"When we fail to put the love of God first, we are easily deceived by crafty men who profess a great love of humanity, while advocating programs that are not of the Lord." (Ezra Taft Benson in CR, Oct. 1967, p. 35. In *The Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles*, Click on "212 Contents" Seek Section 52-16)

†E9. **STORY ABOUT CURTIS:** “Some years ago a wonderful young man named Curtis was called to serve a mission. He was the kind of missionary every mission president prays for. He was focused and worked hard. At one point he was assigned a missionary companion who was immature, socially awkward, and not particularly enthusiastic about getting the work done.

“One day, while they were riding their bicycles, Curtis looked back and saw that his companion had inexplicably gotten off his bike and was walking. Silently, Curtis expressed his frustration to God; what a chore it was to be saddled with a companion he had to drag around in order to accomplish anything. Moments later, Curtis had a profound impression, as if God were saying to him, “You know, Curtis, compared with me, the two of you aren’t all that different.” Curtis learned that he needed to be patient with an imperfect companion who nevertheless was trying in his own way.

“My invitation to all of us is to evaluate our lives, repent, and keep on trying. If we don’t try, we’re just latter-day sinners; if we don’t persevere, we’re latter-day quitters; and if we don’t allow others to try, we’re just latter-day hypocrites. [10] As we try, persevere, and help others to do the same, we are true Latter-day Saints. As we change, we will find that God indeed cares a lot more about who we are and about who we are becoming than about who we once were. [11] (“[Latter-day Saints Keep on Trying](#),” *Ensign*, May 2015)

Recommended Conference Talks:

Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “[You Matter to Him](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2011.
LeGrand R. Curtis Jr., “[Redemption](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2011.
Robert D. Hales, “[Waiting upon the Lord: Thy Will Be Done](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2011.
Quentin L. Cook, “[The Songs They Could Not Sing](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2011.
M. Russell Ballard, “[Finding Joy through Loving Service](#),” *Ensign*, May 2011.
Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “[The Love of God](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2009.

Recommended Reading:

1. Daniel Rona, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#). Select 2015. Scroll down to 2011 NT GD44 and select Daniel Rona Israel Revealed GD supplement.
2. Nancy Jensen, [New Testament Lesson #44 "God Is Love"](#), LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, October 7, 2011.
3. Lenet Read, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#). Select 2015 NT. Scroll down to 2011 NT GD44 and select Lenet Read Gospel Doctrine lesson outlines.

4. Gerald Smith, [New Testament Gospel Doctrine Lesson 44: “God Is Love” 1-3 John](#), Joel’s Monastery, November 07, 2011.

5. Bruce Satterfield, [Lesson 44: “God Is Love”](#), Meridian Magazine, November 2, 2015.

6. Monte Shelley, [NT 44:1-3 John \(apostasy and false teachers\)](#), GD Lesson Notes. Go to [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#). Select 2015 NT. Scroll down to Monte Shelley GD Lesson Notes.

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